HEALTHCARE SERVICES HEALTH TECHNOLOGY

What blockchain products are operating within the healthcare sector?

By **DENTACOIN** • Apr 18, 2018, 6:20AM

Like almost any other sector, the healthcare industry has attracted the attention and interest of blockchain-based product developers in a significant and commendable way. Over the last couple of years, blockchain products aiming at leveraging the healthcare sector have mushroomed from various parts of the globe, with some making a powerful impact and growing speedily. These achievements underline the potential and promise that development of blockchain products will improve the sector.

What challenges are these products responding to? Who are the players/developers on the bandwagon? Let us delve into this subject and answer these questions at length. First, a highlight of emerging startups:

MedRec

Developed by graduates from the Massachusetts Institute of Technology Ariel Ekblaw, Asaf Azaria and Thiago Vieira and Senior Research Scientist Andrew Lippman, MedRec is meant to address one of the industry's major headaches; Electronic Health Records (EHR). MedRec has given special attention to the patients' ability to access and even update their own health record across various providers.

The reward? Medical researchers will be able to mine MedRec and rewarded through gaining access to filtered, census-level data of medical records.

Block Chain Health

The San Francisco based software company formulates HIPAA compliant blockchain-based solutions for organisations. The company is focused on creating products ensuring that data is shareable amongst users such as researchers and policymakers and information safety is highly guaranteed through a tamperproof chain of information storage.

Patientory

From their base in Atlanta, Patientory is exploring the potential of efficiently sharing Electronic Medical Records. Platform users can access the Patientory platform using the digital currency PTOY. The project's whitepaper outlines the patient as the key intermediary in sending and receiving health-information, where frequent updates and software troubleshooting are eliminated thus enhancing efficiency.

Guardtime

Guardtime originates from Estonia, one of the nations whose government has objectively embraced blockchain products. In partnership with e-Health, a government initiative,

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Guardtime provides blockchain-based security to over one million patients. Estonians already have electronic identification credentials linked to other data including health records. The addition of a blockchain protocol reinforces the health data.

Dentacoin

Dentacoin is a revolutionary blockchain-based platform that is built primarily for the dental industry. It is headquartered in Netherlands and has made several positive strides since its establishment in February 2017. The project runs under Dentacoin Foundation and has so far developed DentaCare Mobile App, DentaVox Research and Dentacoin Trusted Reviews whose role is to connect all market participants through valuable feedback and rewards.

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Although it's been around for a far shorter period than other products, Dentacoin has already been implemented for payment across 21 dental clinics around the world. From the USA to the UK, Italy, Serbia, Hungary among 13 countries in total.

An ambitious product by Dentacoin, known as Dentacoin Assurance is under development. It aims at shifting the focus from treatment to prevention. Once it is rolled out, Dentacoin Assurance will help patients cover the costs for dental treatments through low monthly fees paid in the same-named cryptocurrency.

What challenges are these products responding to?

EHR / EMR: From the onset, medical records have received significant focus amongst most of the products being developed. Enhanced data sharing among various practitioners and shareholders such as insurance companies is one important element that products aim to leverage.

Payments: Products are also looking at how best payments for healthcare services can be done with much ease through digital currency and cryptocurrency.

Drug System: Pharmaceutical research, as well as drug-issuing in healthcare facilities, has also attracted blockchain developers and there is positive progress to this end.

Research: Access to data for research needs is seemingly getting easier as industry players find ways of sharing data through blockchain products

It is only getting better

These products highlighted are just a tip of the iceberg. Several more are in various stages of development and the industry is poised for rapid growth as time goes. Governments, developers and other players in the industry will, however, need to put in place policy and frameworks that guide these developments especially in ensuring the safety of sensitive data. Nonetheless, it is clear that blockchain will be instrumental in providing solutions to major healthcare processes such as data collection, storage and sharing.

The currency Dentacoin (DCN) is already listed on international exchange platforms and accepted as a means of payment at more than 20 clinics in 13 countries, as well as by dental labs and suppliers.

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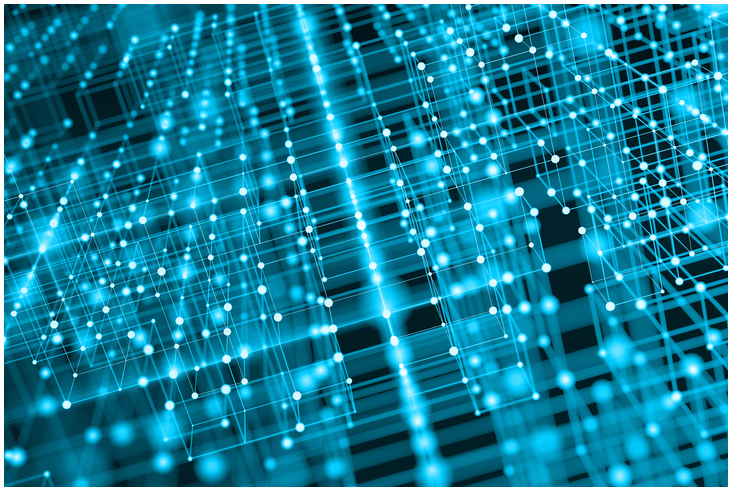

Renowned for its high-quality patient care and known as one of the best hospitals in the US, The Mayo Clinic has partnered with UK blockchain start-up Medicalchain to support the development of future services.

Mayo Clinic is top ranked in a wide range of specialities, including diabetes and endocrinology

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Investing $383mn in 2017 to support the local community Mercy Health has sought to provide high quality services, serving over 250,000 people with over 244 programmes.

The largest non-profit healthcare system in Ohio, the organisation has established a data platform that uses real-world clinical

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